4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

# Which products and services are growing?

**Period: September 2026.** Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

**How final is this data?**

**September 2026** Locked September 2026 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2026). These numbers won't change.

## Trades

**Gross margin, not profit**

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

**From gross margin to profit**

September's jobs made $96,230 gross margin (42.7%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $28,417 and overheads $59,580, leaving $8,233 profit before tax (3.7% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 39.0% gross margin on average.

| | |
|---|---|
| Gross margin on jobs | $96,230 |
| Technician wages and on-costs | $79,587 |
| Technician time charged to jobs (at cost) | $51,170 |
| Technician time not charged to jobs | $28,417 |
| Gross profit (the P&L) | $67,813 |
| Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest) | $59,580 |
| Profit before tax (the P&L) | $8,233 |
| Revenue | $225,460 |
| Gross margin on jobs, % | 42.7% |
| Profit before tax, % of revenue | 3.7% |
| **Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged** | **39.0%** |

## Line: All

September against September last year
**57.6%**
$225,460 against $143,077

Year to date against the same period last year
**26.4%**
$640,593 against $506,783

Gross margin, year to date
**44.3%**
$283,869 before overheads

**What it shows**

Revenue is 26.4% up on the same period last year, year to date ($640,593 against $506,783). Maintenance contracts make the highest gross margin (63.9%); Installations the lowest (37.0%). The business needs 39.0% gross margin just to cover overheads.

**What you'd do about it**

Installations: 37.0% gross margin, 2.0 points over the 35.0% target ($8,257 ahead on $412,100 this financial year to date). Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($39,281 ahead on $136,050 this financial year to date).

## Line: Maintenance contracts

September against September last year
**21.9%**
$45,350 against $37,200

Year to date against the same period last year
**21.9%**
$136,050 against $111,600

Gross margin, year to date
**63.9%**
$86,898 before overheads

**What it shows**
Maintenance contracts brought in $136,050 this financial year to date, 21.9% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 26.4%), at a 63.9% gross margin (above the 44.3% overall).

**What you'd do about it**
Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($39,281 ahead on $136,050 this financial year to date).

## Line: Installations

September against September last year
**73.8%**
$146,300 against $84,200

Year to date against the same period last year
**23.8%**
$412,100 against $332,800

Gross margin, year to date
**37.0%**
$152,492 before overheads

**What it shows**
Installations brought in $412,100 this financial year to date, 23.8% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 26.4%), at a 37.0% gross margin (below the 44.3% overall).

**What you'd do about it**
Installations: 37.0% gross margin, 2.0 points over the 35.0% target ($8,257 ahead on $412,100 this financial year to date).

## Line: Call-outs and repairs

September against September last year
**56.0%**
$33,810 against $21,677

Year to date against the same period last year
**48.2%**
$92,443 against $62,383

Gross margin, year to date
**48.1%**
$44,479 before overheads

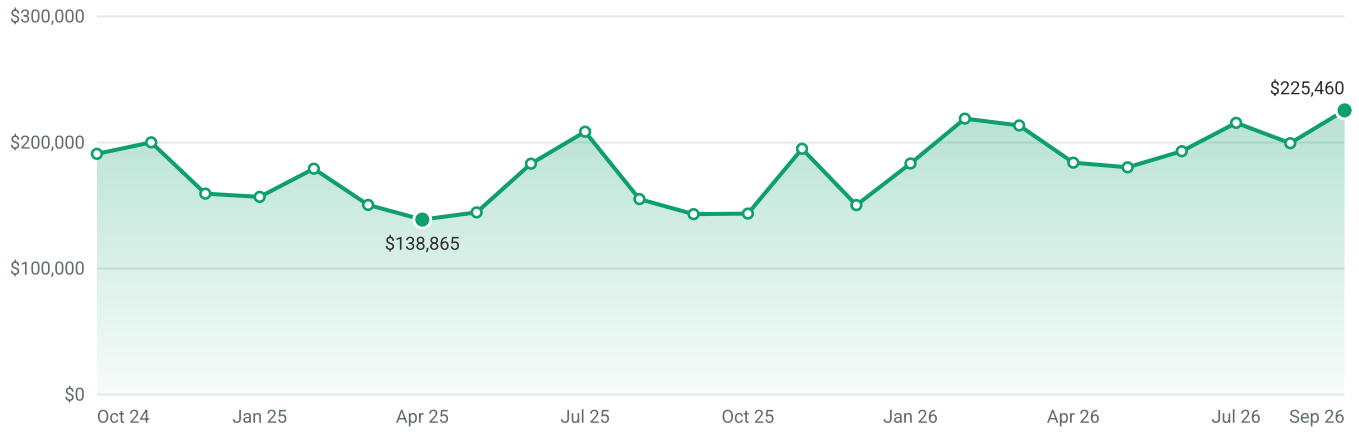
**What it shows**
Call-outs and repairs brought in $92,443 this financial year to date, 48.2% on the same period last year (faster than the business as a whole, 26.4%), at a 48.1% gross margin (above the 44.3% overall).

**What you'd do about it**
Call-outs and repairs: 48.1% gross margin, 13.1 points over the 35.0% target ($12,124 ahead on $92,443 this financial year to date).

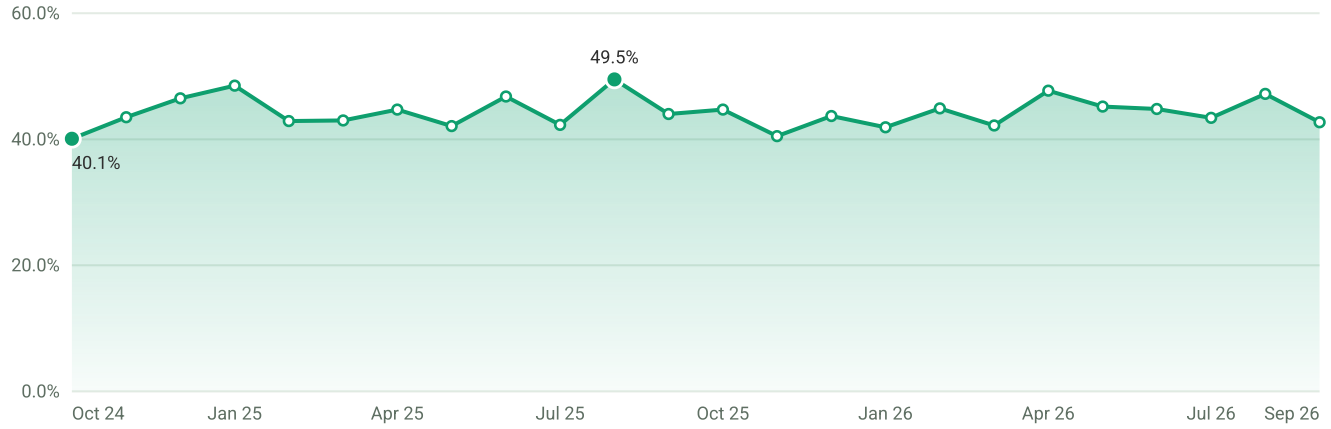
## Every line at once

### Revenue, gross margin and growth by line, by month

**All · Revenue $**



**All · Gross margin %**




Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

## By line: financial year to date (Jul to Sep 2026) against the same period last year

| | Year to date | Same period last year | Growth | Gross margin $ | Gross margin % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Maintenance contracts | $136,050 | $111,600 | 21.9% | $86,898 | 63.9% |
| Installations | $412,100 | $332,800 | 23.8% | $152,492 | 37.0% |
| Call-outs and repairs | $92,443 | $62,383 | 48.2% | $44,479 | 48.1% |
| Total | $640,593 | $506,783 | 26.4% | $283,869 | 44.3% |

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.